

Final Report: Formalities

1. You team up in **groups up to 5 students**. Try to form groups of *at least* 3 students.
2. **Form your teams until November 13**. If you are having trouble finding partners, please reach out to pheiler@econ.au.dk by Nov 13, 13:00 - so we can help you.
3. You do **not** have to inform us about the groups before final submission.
4. You will be provided an article and data by us in **calendar week 46**.
5. **You write a 9–10 page research paper** based based on the article and data.
6. You may submit questions regarding the report until **December 02, 13:00** to pheiler@econ.au.dk.
7. You submit your paper by **December 31, 13:00** via wiseflow.
8. In wiseflow you will be able to form groups and submit as a group. You do not have to hand-in multiple versions of the same paper. Make sure all student IDs + full names within your group are part of the wiseflow submission and written on the title page.
9. You will **not** receive a grade for the report. The assement is the individual oral exam. However, the report will be the basis for parts of the oral exam. The better your report, the easier it is to progress to questions that can get you up to a very good grade.

Below is a template how to structure your report with approximate length suggestions. This is meant as guidance to you, but is not a compulsory structure.

Page -1: Title Page - Student IDs + full names & Topic

Page 0: Table of contents

Introduction (1.5 pages)

1. Provide a brief explanation of the problem area (based on the topic, rephrased in your own words).
2. Give a broad overview of the data, including:
 - Types of variables available.
 - Whether the data is experimental or observational.
 - Structure of the data (cross-section, time-series, or panel).
 - Data size.
3. Clearly and precisely state the main research question(s) addressed in your report.

Data Handling & Descriptive/Predictive Evidence (1 page)

1. Explain the data-cleaning steps, including any redefinition of variables or deletion of observations.
2. Describe the **main variables** used in your analysis and provide details about the sample.
3. Provide and interpret predictive or associational relationships relevant to the main research question.
4. Reflect on the limitations of this predictive analysis in relation to your research question.

Causal Analysis of Main Research Question (4.5 to 5 pages)

1. Introduce an appropriate causal model and define the target parameters (Task 1 of Trinity). Choose a preferred formalization method (e.g., structural equation models, graphs, potential outcomes).
2. Discuss the assumptions and identification strategy (Task 2 of Trinity).
3. Provide estimation and statistical inference for the main parameter(s) and model specification(s) (Task 3 of Trinity).
4. Interpret and discuss the main results.
5. Discuss practical considerations and limitations of the analysis.

Robustness Checks and Extensions (2.5 - 3 pages)

1. Select and discuss methods that relax assumptions made in the previous section and/or present credible alternative model specifications.
2. Report and test these alternative specifications.
3. Overall brief conclusion regarding the robustness of the main results.

Bibliography

Include main references.

Additional Comments

1. Read and discuss the main reference with each other.
2. The data source might slightly differ from the original study, see the full description of Topics.
3. The report should be 9–10 pages long, with an additional 10 pages available for the Appendix (font size 11, 1.5 line spacing). Bibliography has no page limit, but extensive referencing is typically unnecessary.

4. Use precise technical language and definitions throughout.
5. Emphasize and discuss critical assumptions, particularly when they are untestable (e.g., the exclusion and independence restrictions in IV analysis).
6. When introducing models and assumptions, avoid directly copying content from lectures or books. Tailor the explanation to the specific problem.
7. Focus on main parameters relevant to the research question and include only important specification tests.
8. Use appropriate standard errors and uncertainty quantification for your data and methods.
9. Avoid cluttering sections with large tables or outputs containing irrelevant information (e.g. unrelated statistical tests or coefficients of controls that are not part of the main hypothesis).
10. Place secondary or auxiliary information in the Appendix (up to 10 pages).
11. Reference all tables, figures, and outputs properly within the text.
12. Include proper citations and references to sources as needed.
13. You can, but do not have to, discuss differences in result in relation to the main reference. For example, if you relax some of the assumptions made in the paper or, e.g., provide estimates with different internal or external validity, you can discuss why there are differences based on your analysis.